opportunity either way. The required trust and goodwill have not been evident in the process to date. Secondly, continuing to frame these conflicts as being about 'ethnic' minorities risks undermining the breadth and depth of social and political change required for lasting peace. Most Burmans want greater political rights and decentralization of power too. Conflating multiple conflict dynamics and fault lines into a simplistic 'ethnic' label poses the danger that any renegotiation of political rights, power distribution, and decentralization will not address the demands and aspirations of the diversity of people involved. A long-term solution to both authoritarianism and conflict in Myanmar may require resolving questions of political rights, power distribution, and decentralized authority across the whole country, not just in 'ethnic' states, for example. There is thus a real danger that focus on this being a political dialogue with 'ethnic minorities' around ethnic nationalism, federalism, and a peace process could be counter-productive to the broader constitutional reform required.

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